been proved when on 15 December 2003 the Royal Bhutan Army launched an offensive against the Indian Insurgent groups operating from its territory. The move was closely coordinated with the centre, and the goal was to wipe out the 30 camps of the militant outfits in southern Bhutan. The Royal Bhutanese army has just 6,000 soldiers fighting against 2,500 insurgents, which might seem too insufficient for the “Operation All Clear”.

The Gorkhaland problem has also made India very cautious towards her relations with Bhutan. The resurgence of the Gorkhaland problem in 2007-2008 under Bimal Gurung and the Gorkha Janamukhti Morcha (GJM), with their demand for a “Gorkhaland” which plans to incorporate areas within the plains in Siliguri and Duars as well, the India Government continues to be cautious while addressing the Lhotshmapa‡‡ refugee crisis. It continues to exhibit the posture of neutrality regarding the crisis and treats the matter as a bilateral issue between Nepal and Bhutan.

However, China has always been a constant factor in Indo-Bhutan relation. The British India Government was also cautious about Chinese intentions and so is the Government of Independent India. The 1949 Treaty concluded between Bhutan and Independent India is nothing but a continuation of the British legacy and it continued to be the guiding principle of Indo-Bhutan relation till 2007 when the Treaty was renegotiated and a new Treaty came up in its place.

Article 2 of the 1949 Treaty upheld that:

“The Government of India undertakes to exercise no interference in the internal administration of Bhutan. On its part the Government of Bhutan agrees to be guided by the advice of the Government of India in regard to its external relations.”

Article 2 of the new Indo-Bhutan Friendship Treaty of 2007 now read as follows:

“In keeping with the abiding ties of close friendship and cooperation between Bhutan and India, the Government of the Kingdom of Bhutan and the Government of the Republic of India shall cooperate closely with each other on issues relating to their national interests. Neither Government shall allow the use of its territory for activities harmful to the national security and interest of the other.”